A.R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

July 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: *Safety Recall 01S21 Supplement #1*

1. *Additional Part Information*
2. *Revised Rental Car Information*
3. *Dealer Announcement dated 12/17/98, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure*

REFERENCE: DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21: Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car, and Windstar vehicles - Seat Belt Buckle Retention

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car, and Windstar vehicles.

SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles, it is possible that the driver's and/or front passenger's outboard seat belt buckle may not fully latch. In the event of an accident, the restraint system may not provide the designed level of occupant protection.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must inspect the front driver's seat and outboard front passenger's seat belt buckle for proper latch performance. This inspection must be performed by using a special dealership tool developed to identify 100% of the potentially defective buckles. It is anticipated that the tool will likely reject between 15 and 25% of buckles tested (this could equate to 50% of vehicles tested), although the actual defect rate is believed to be less than 5% (See Q & A for further details). This is acceptable to ensure all of the potentially defective buckles are identified. If, during the inspection, it is found that either buckle will not pass the special tool test, it must be replaced. The inspection tools should have arrived at your dealership on Monday, 7/16/01. If the inspection tool has not arrived, is unusable, or has been damaged, please contact the Special Service Support Center.

If a customer should have questions regarding this concern, instruct them to **quickly and firmly** push the seat belt tongue into the buckle and to pull it to help ensure the seat belt is securely latched, before driving their vehicle to your dealership. If the seat belt buckle release button does not return to its full up position, the buckle may not be fully latched (see Owner Letter).

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

LINCOLN COMMITMENT SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Lincoln owners affected by this recall. Please see dealer announcement dated 12/17/98, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure. The special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer Lincoln owners convenient vehicle handling.

Lincoln Mercury is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for these customers.

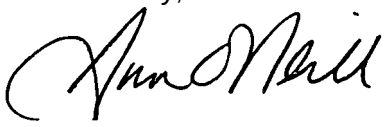
ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV Dealer Q & A
Order Form for Low Volume Parts
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Special Service Support Center:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21
Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 – F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car, and Windstar vehicles
Seat Belt Buckle Retention

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Online Involved Unit Listing available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any of your affected owners whose names are not on your VIN list but whose vehicles are identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

Note: Lincoln Owners should receive the " Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure". Before calling Lincoln owners, please review the dealer announcement to familiarize yourself with this special handling procedure.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs applicable to this recall, which were made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles will be provided for customers who have had their vehicle inspected, and found to require replacement parts. Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle while a customer's vehicle is down or waiting for parts. Fuel and insurance will be at the owner's expense. Follow Extended Service Plan (ESP) guidelines for rental dollar amounts. Enter the word "RENTAL", plus the number of days the vehicle was used, in the Miscellaneous Expense area of the claim. Parts must be ordered so they will be received in the fastest manner possible while the customer is using a rental vehicle.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21
Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 Through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car and Windstar – Seat Belt Buckle Retention

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Vehicle	Operation	Time (Hrs)	Labor Operation
All	**Administration**	0.1	ADMIN
All	**Inspect (no buckle replacements)**	0.3	01S21A
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling (does not apply to vehicles in dealer stock)	*Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"*	*See Special Handling Letter*	
Crown Victoria/ Grand Marquis	**Bucket Seats** *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.7	01S21C
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.2	01S21H
	60/40 Split Bench Seat *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.7	01S21C
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.0	01S21F
Town Car	**40/20/40 Split Bench Seat With Side Airbags**		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	1.8	01S21M
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	2.1	01S21N
	40/20/40 Split Bench Seat Without Side Airbags		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.7	01S21C
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.0	01S21F
Ranger (All)	**With Buckle Pre-Tensioners**		
	60/40 Split Bench Seat		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	1.3	01S21Q
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.6	01S21J
	Without Buckle Pre-Tensioners		
	60/40 Split Bench Seat		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.7	01S21C
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.1	01S21G
Expedition/ Navigator	**Bucket Seats With or Without Side Air Bags**		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.8	01S21D
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.9	01S21E
	60/40 Split Bench Seat *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.4	01S21O
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.5	01S21P

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

	Without SIR		
F-150	**Bucket Seats** *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.6	01S21B
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.7	01S21C
	60/40 Split Bench Seat *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.4	01S21O
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.6	01S21B
	Full Bench Seat *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.4	01S21O
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.5	01S21P
	With SIR		
	Bucket Seats *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	1.1	01S21G
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.4	01S21I
	60/40 Split Bench Seat *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	1.2	01S21H
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.4	01S21I
Excursion	**Bucket Seats (***with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) OR (2) Two Seat Belt Buckles	0.7	01S21C
	40/20/40 Split Bench Seat		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.7	01S21C
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.9	01S21E
F-Super Duty	**With SIR**		
	Bucket Seats *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	1.1	01S21G
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.4	01S21I
	40/20/40 Split Bench Seat *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	1.1	01S21G
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	1.4	01S21I
	Without SIR		
	Bucket Seats *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) OR (2) Two Seat Belt Buckles	0.7	01S21C
	60/40 Split Bench Seat *(with or without power seats)*		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) OR (2) Two Seat Belt Buckles	0.7	01S21C
	Full Bench Seat		
	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.5	01S21P
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.6	01S21B
Windstar	Inspect and Replace One (1) Seat Belt Buckle	0.5	01S21P
	Inspect and Replace Two (2) Seat Belt Buckles	0.7	01S21C

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Parts shown below with an asterisk (*) represent low volume vehicle seat belt buckles that will require special ordering. If it is found that a part designated with an asterisk (*) is needed, you are requested to use the attached order form, and FAX the information to the Special Service Support Center (1-800-998-1717). All other parts are available through the normal order process and do not require a call to the Special Service Support Center.

Dealers are encouraged to only order seat belt buckles to repair vehicles that have failed the technician inspection process using the special tool provided.

Parts without an asterisk (*)	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Parts marked with an asterisk (*)	First 30 days after launch	**Fax 1-800-998-1717**
Parts marked with an asterisk (*)	31 days after launch	Normal order process

Vehicle	Color	Left-Hand	Right-Hand
Crown Vic Grand Marquis	Denim Light Parchment Med Graphite Med Parchment Midnight Black	1W7Z-5461202-AAD *1W7Z-5461202-AAA 1W7Z-5461202-AAB 1W7Z-5461202-AAC 1W7Z-5461202-AAE	1W7Z-5461202-AAD *1W7Z-5461202-AAA 1W7Z-5461202-AAB 1W7Z-5461202-AAC 1W7Z-5461202-AAE
Lincoln Town Car	Denim Med Parchment Med/Lt Graphite Med/Lt Parchment Midnight Black	*1W1Z-5461202-AAA *1W1Z-5461202-AAE 1W1Z-5461202-AAB 1W1Z-5461202-AAD 1W1Z-5461202-AAC	*1W1Z-5461202-AAA *1W1Z-5461202-AAE 1W1Z-5461202-AAB 1W1Z-5461202-AAD 1W1Z-5461202-AAC
Windstar Power	Med Graphite Med Parchment	1F2Z-1661203-AAB 1F2Z-1661203-AAA	1F2Z-1661202-AAB 1F2Z-1661202-AAA
Windstar Manual	Med Graphite Med Parchment	1F2Z-1661203-BAB 1F2Z-1661203-BAA	1F2Z-1661202-AAB 1F2Z-1661202-AAA
Ranger	Black	1L5Z-1061203-AAA	1L5Z-1061202-AAA

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information - Continued

Vehicle	Color	Left-Hand	Right-Hand
Excursion Manual Bucket	Dark Denim Blue Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1C3Z-2561203-BAB 1C3Z-2561203-BAC *1C3Z-2561203-BAA	*1L7Z-7861202-AAF 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
Excursion Power Bucket	Dark Denim Blue Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1C3Z-2561203-CAB 1C3Z-2561203-CAC 1C3Z-2561203-CAA	*1L7Z-7861202-AAF 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
Excursion Manual 40/20/40 Bench	Dark Denim Blue Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1C3Z-2561203-BAB 1C3Z-2561203-BAC *1C3Z-2561203-BAA	*1L7Z-7861202-AAF 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
Excursion Power 40/20/40 Bench	Dark Denim Blue Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1C3Z-2561203-CAB 1C3Z-2561203-CAC 1C3Z-2561203-CAA	*1L7Z-7861202-AAF 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
Expedition Manual Bucket	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1L7Z-7861203-AAG *1L7Z-7861203-AAH *1L7Z-7861203-AAF	1L7Z-7861202-AAC 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
Expedition Power Bucket	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1L7Z-7861203-BAC 1L7Z-7861203-BAB 1L7Z-7861203-BAA	1L7Z-7861202-AAC 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
Expedition Navigator Power Bucket	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1L7Z-7861203-BAC 1L7Z-7861203-BAB 1L7Z-7861203-BAA	*1L7Z-7861202-BAD 1L7Z-7861202-BAC 1L7Z-7861202-BAB
Navigator Power Bucket with Memory	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L7Z-7861203-CAC 1L7Z-7861203-CAB 1L7Z-7861203-CAA	*1L7Z-7861202-BAD 1L7Z-7861202-BAC 1L7Z-7861202-BAB
Expedition 60/40 Bench	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1L7Z-7861203-AAG *1L7Z-7861203-AAH *1L7Z-7861203-AAF	1L7Z-78612B18-AAB 1L7Z-78612B18-AAC 1L7Z-78612B18-AAA
F150 Super Crew Bench	Black Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1L7Z-7861203-CAD 1L7Z-7861203-CAC 1L7Z-7861203-CAB 1L7Z-7861203-CAA	1L7Z-7861202-BAA *1L7Z-7861202-BAD 1L7Z-7861202-BAC 1L7Z-7861202-BAB

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information – Continued

Vehicle	Color	Left-Hand	Right-Hand
F150 Super Crew Bucket	Black Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	*1L7Z-7861203-CAD 1L7Z-7861203-CAC 1L7Z-7861203-CAB 1L7Z-7861203-CAA	*1L7Z-7861202-BAA *1L7Z-7861202-BAD 1L7Z-7861202-BAC 1L7Z-7861202-BAB
F150 Super Crew 60/40 Bench	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L7Z-7861203-CAC 1L7Z-7861203-CAB 1L7Z-7861203-CAA	*1L7Z-78612B18-AAB 1L7Z-78612B18-AAC 1L7Z-78612B18-AAA
F250/550 SD Regular Cab 40/20/40 Bench	*Dark Denim Blue* Med Graphite Med Parchment	**1C3Z-2561203-BAB* 1C3Z-2561203-BAC *1C3Z-2561203-BAA	**1L7Z-7861202-AAF* 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
F250/550 SD Regular Cab Bucket	*Dark Denim Blue* Med Graphite Med Parchment	**1C3Z-2561203-CAB* 1C3Z-2561203-CAC 1C3Z-2561203-CAA	**1L7Z-7861202-AAF* 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
F250/550 SD Crew Cab 40/20/40 Bench	*Dark Denim Blue* Med Graphite Med Parchment	**1C3Z-2561203-BAB* 1C3Z-2561203-BAC *1C3Z-2561203-BAA	**1L7Z-7861202-AAF* 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
F250/550 SD Crew Cab Bucket	*Dark Denim Blue* Med Graphite Med Parchment	**1C3Z-2561203-CAB* 1C3Z-2561203-CAC 1C3Z-2561203-CAA	**1L7Z-7861202-AAF* 1L7Z-7861202-AAB 1L7Z-7861202-AAA
F250/550 SD Super Cab *40/20/40* **Bench (SIR)**	Black	1C3Z-2861203-AAA	1L3Z-1861202-AAA
F250/550 SD Super Cab Bucket (SIR)	Black	1C3Z-2861203-AAA	1L3Z-1861202-AAA
F150 Regular Cab Bench	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L3Z-15612B19-AAF *1L3Z-15612B19-AAE *1L3Z-15612B19-AAD	1L3Z-15612B18-AAC 1L3Z-15612B18-AAB *1L3Z-15612B18-AAA
F150 Regular Cab Power 60/40 Bench	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L3Z-1561203-BAC *1L3Z-1561203-BAB 1L3Z-1561203-BAA	1L3Z-15612B18-AAC 1L3Z-15612B18-AAB *1L3Z-15612B18-AAA

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information – Continued

Vehicle	Color	Left-Hand	Right-Hand
F150 Regular Cab Manual 60/40 Bench	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L3Z-1561203-AAC *1L3Z-1561203-AAB *1L3Z-1561203-AAA	1L3Z-15612B18-AAC 1L3Z-15612B18-AAB *1L3Z-15612B18-AAA
F150 Regular Cab Power Bucket	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L3Z-1561203-BAC 1L3Z-1561203-BAB 1L3Z-1561203-BAA	*1L3Z-1561202-AAC *1L3Z-1561202-AAD *1L3Z-1561202-AAE
F150 Regular Cab Manual Bucket	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L3Z-1561203-AAC *1L3Z-1561203-AAB *1L3Z-1561203-AAA	*1L3Z-1561202-AAC *1L3Z-1561202-AAD *1L3Z-1561202-AAE
F150 Super Cab Bench	Dark Graphite Med Graphite Med Parchment	1L3Z-15612B19-AAF *1L3Z-15612B19-AAE *1L3Z-15612B19-AAD	1L3Z-15612B18-AAC 1L3Z-15612B18-AAB *1L3Z-15612B18-AAA
F150 Super Cab - 60/40 Bench (SIR)	Black	1L3Z-1861203-AAA	1L3Z-1861202-AAA
F150 Super Cab - Bucket (SIR)	Black	1L3Z-1861203-AAA	1L3Z-1861202-AAA
Seatbelt Extension	Black	1L3Z-54611C22-AA	1L3Z-54611C22-AA

Note: Seatbelt buckles annotated with an asterisk (*) above require special ordering.
(See above, page 3 of 6). *CHECK LATEST PARTS INFORMATION AT WWW.QCDEALER.COM, WHAT'S NEW PAGE FOR DAILY HOTLINK TO PS&L'S UPDATES.*

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information – Continued

SPECIAL PARTS NOTE – SEAT BELT EXTENSION

The seatbelt extension, 1L3Z-54611C22-AA, listed above must also be inspected with the special tool provided and replaced as necessary. If the dealer has knowledge of a vehicle that has had this item installed, contact the owner, provide a copy of the attached owner notification letter, and schedule a service appointment.

ORDER INFORMATION

DOR/COR number is 50249. This number identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Special Service Support Center (1-800-998-1717).

DESTROY/DISABLE REMOVED BUCKLES

Potentially defective seat belt buckles that have been removed from a vehicle should be destroyed to prevent them from unintentionally being used on another vehicle.

PARTS PURGE

NOTE: Dealers must use claim reason code "GC" and reference program 01S21 in the comments box on the claim form.

Inspect dealer stock and purge all suspect seat belt buckles identified in the above chart that have the following packaging date code (on or before this date):

052701 - Month, Day and Year format. Parts with this date or earlier must be purged.

PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for “Parts Retention and Return Procedures”.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to DOES II or updated price book.

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company™

ORDER FORM
PROGRAM 01S21

COMPLETE THE FORM AND FAX OR EMAIL TO:

FAX #: 1-800-998-1717
(a receipt confirmation will be faxed back to you)

OR

EMAIL TO: FORD@RENKIM.COM
(a receipt confirmation will be emailed back to you)

THIS ORDER FORM IS TO BE USED FOR "K" CODED PART ORDERS ONLY.

PLEASE PRINT LEGIBLY.

DEALERSHIP INFORMATION:

DEALER CONTACT FIRST NAME:_____ LAST NAME: _____

DEALER P/A CODE: ☐☐☐☐☐

DEALERSHIP NAME:_____

ADDRESS: _____

CITY: _____STATE: _____ZIP:_____

TELEPHONE #: _____ EXTENSION: _____

FAX #: _____ EMAIL ADDRESS:_____

VIN # : ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

REPAIR ORDER #: ☐☐☐☐☐☐

HAS THE VEHICLE BEEN INSPECTED? ☐ Yes ☐ No
(Please CHECK one)

Right Hand

PART # REQUIRED: ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐

Left Hand

☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐

Color: _____

ORDER TYPE: ☐ EMERGENCY ☐ NTERIM ☐ TOCK (Please CHECK one)

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21

Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 Through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car and Windstar – Seat Belt Buckle Retention

Q & A (updated July 25th)

Q.1 **Is this a recall?**
A.1 Yes, this is a supplier-initiated voluntary safety recall.

Q.2 **How many vehicles are involved in this program?**
A.2 Approximately 1.4 million 2001 model year vehicles.

PLEASE NOTE: THE NHTSA SITE IDENTIFIES THE "POTENTIAL NUMBER OF UNITS AFFECTED" AS 3,000,000. SINCE, IN NHTSA'S TERMS, THIS IS AN EQUIPMENT RECALL, THE 3 MILLION REFERS TO THE NUMBER OF BUCKLES AFFECTED, **NOT** THE NUMBER OF AFFECTED VEHICLES.

Vehicles affected are:

- About 83,820 Ford Crown Victoria vehicles built at the St. Thomas Assembly Plant from 4/17/00 until 5/29/01.
- About 98,150 Mercury Grand Marquis vehicles built at St. Thomas from 4/17/00 until 5/29/01.
- About 63,547 Lincoln Town Cars built at Wixom from 3/27/00 until 5/30/01.
- About 203,542 Ford Windstars built at Oakville from 3/23/00 until 5/30/01.
- About 245,298 Ford Rangers built at Twin Cities Assembly Plant from 3/28/00 until 5/30/01, and at Edison from 3/13/00 until 5/25/01.
- About 318,980 Ford F-150 trucks built at Norfolk from 4/18/00 until 5/25/01, at Ontario from 5/10/00 until 5/28/01, at Kansas City from 9/11/99 until 5/25/01 and at Cuautitlan from 5/16/00 until 6/09/01.
- About 178,191 Ford Super Duty F-250/550 trucks built at Kentucky Truck Plant from 4/17/00 until 5/27/01 and at the Cuautitlan Assembly Plant from 5/16/00 until 6/19/01.
- About 23,104 Ford Excursion trucks built at Kentucky Truck from 4/17/00 until 10/2/00.
- About 161,083 Ford Expedition vehicles built at the Michigan Truck Plant from 4/11/00 until 5/31/01.
- About 31,507 Lincoln Navigators built at Michigan Truck from 4/11/00 until 5/31/01.

Q.3 **Is Explorer affected?**
A.3 No, Explorer uses a different buckle made by a different supplier.

Q.4 **How many of these vehicles are still on dealer lots? How many have been sold?**
A.4 There are approximately 394,000 unsold and approximately 1,000,000 sold.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21

Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 Through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car and Windstar – Seat Belt Buckle Retention

Q & A (updated July 25th)

Q.5 **What is the issue?**
A.5 Seat belt tongues that are not inserted into the buckle firmly may not latch properly. If the buckle is not properly latched, the seat belt may not provide the intended level of occupant protection in the event of a crash. The possibility of a non-latch condition is present only if several different manufacturing conditions are present in the same buckle.

Q.6 **What seating positions in the vehicle may have these potentially defective buckles?**
A.6 The driver and the front outboard passenger seating positions are the only positions that use this particular buckle.

Q.7 **Is this a potential "real world" safety issue?**
A.7 This is an issue that could affect real world safety. All of the buckles are capable of being fully latched and will comply with all safety regulations when latched.
The safety issue is the potential for an inadequate latch if the buckles are fastened slowly or with low force.

Q.8 **Why are vehicles built before and after the dates of this action not affected by this recall? Why are other 2001 models not affected?**
A.8 These seat belt buckles are brand new for the 2001 MY. The remaining 2001 MY vehicle models do not utilize this buckle.

Q.9 **What is the fix?**
A.9 Dealers will inspect vehicles to determine which buckles may actually be affected. Buckles, which fail the dealership inspection, will be replaced.

Q.10 **When will you alert owners?**
A.10 In July (All owner letters will be mailed between 7/25/01 and 7/27/01).

Q.11 **What would you tell customers who are concerned about driving their vehicles?**
A.11 Customers can take steps to help ensure that the seat belt is buckled properly until they are able to bring their vehicle in to the dealer for inspection, by firmly and rapidly pushing the tongue into the buckle and then wiggling it to confirm a solid latch. Customers may also check visually to ensure that the seat belt buckle release button has returned to its full up position. Customers should then take their vehicle to their dealership who will conduct the approved inspection procedure to determine if they have an affected buckle.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21

Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 Through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car and Windstar – Seat Belt Buckle Retention

Q & A (updated July 25th)

Q.12 **Tell me about the test – will it catch all defective buckles?**

A.12 A special tool has been developed to identify 100% of the potentially faulty buckles. It may also reject some good buckles. This is acceptable to make sure we get all defective buckles out of these vehicles. The device has a special seat belt tongue designed specifically to identify potentially defective buckles. It is screwed down on the buckle - if the buckle releases, it must be replaced.

Q.13 **How many buckles are defective?**

A.13 Based on the evaluations performed at dealers, and the results of the 'plant sort' in production, the number of **buckles** that are expected to fail the inspection is between 15 and 25%. There is some evidence, although TRW has not been able to find anything in the design or assembly process to substantiate it, that vehicles built from April onwards have a greater likelihood of containing a 'defective' buckle, or at least a buckle that fails the inspection, than those built before April. We have also observed that, in many cases, vehicles contain only one defective belt - hence 25% of **buckles** that fail the inspection may equate to 50% of **vehicles** that have to be sidelined for repair.
Further, from our evaluations, of the buckles that failed the inspection and were 'torn down' by TRW, only a relatively small number proved to actually be defective. That number equates to "less than 5%" of the total number of buckles inspected.

Q.14 **If I test a buckle multiple times, or use a different tool to 'check' a result, sometimes the buckle passes, sometimes it fails. Am I doing something wrong?**

A.14 Not necessarily. The tool has been designed so that, when used as detailed in the inspection procedure, it will catch all defective buckles. It has been developed so that many of the variables (angle of insertion; speed of insertion; load applied; etc.) are minimized. However, buckles and tools are all subject to some small degree of manufacturing variability and, therefore, some variability in test results is to be expected. From our own evaluations, buckles that sometimes pass, sometimes fail, when torn down, have always proven to be OK – but, to be sure all defective buckles are captured, any buckle that fails the inspection must be replaced.

Q.15 **What if my vehicle is equipped with a seat belt extension for the driver or front seat passenger?**

A.15 If your vehicle has been equipped with seat belt extensions for the driver or front seat passenger, please bring them with you when you visit your dealership to also have them inspected.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21

Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 Through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car and Windstar – Seat Belt Buckle Retention

Q & A (updated July 25th)

Q.16 **My tool was broken/damaged when I received it, what should I do?**
A.16 Please do not attempt to use the tool in its broken/damaged state as the results of any inspection may be invalid. Contact the Special Service Support Center on 1-800-325-5621 and request a replacement tool. This will sent to you by overnight courier.

Q.17 **What should I do with the broken tool?**
A.17 Please send it back to the Special Service Support Center, c/o Renkim Corporation, 13333 Allen Road, Southgate, MI 48195-2294. Returned tools will be repaired and re-certified for future use.

Q.18 **I have a customer vehicle which requires a replacement buckle. Is car rental available while I wait for the parts(s) to be delivered?**
A.18 Car rental is available – for customer vehicles that have been tested and found to require a replacement buckle. Approval from the Special Service Support Center is **not** required. Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle while a customer's vehicle is down or waiting for parts. Fuel and insurance will be at the owner's expense. Follow Extended Service Plan (ESP) guidelines for rental dollar amounts. Enter the word "RENTAL", plus the number of days the vehicle was used, in the Miscellaneous Expense area of the claim. Parts must be ordered so they will be received in the fastest manner possible while the customer is using a rental vehicle.

Q.19 **I've found that if I screw the tool down all the way, I can test vehicles very quickly by repeatedly inserting the exposed tongue into the buckles – is this OK?**
A.19 NO!!
DO NOT TEST BUCKLES IN THIS WAY.
Tests performed will be invalid. It is very important that the tool is used precisely as described in the Technical Instructions, and that all the warnings there are followed. The speed, force and angle at which the tongue is inserted into the buckle are extremely important. The tool has been developed to minimize the impact of these variables, and it must be used as described to properly inspect the buckles and sort good from potentially bad.

Q.20 **If I use the tool to inspect buckles fitted to 2001 MY vehicles outside of the population described in the Dealer Bulletin (and therefore not included in OASIS), I find that the tool 'fails' some of these buckles. Are these buckles bad too?**
A.20 There is no need to inspect parts fitted to vehicles that are not part of the affected population. TRW have certified all parts used in production vehicles after a certain date – this date varies from plant to plant, but is reflected in the population of affected vehicles that we have identified (see Q.2 above).

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S21

Certain 2001 Model Year Crown Victoria, Excursion, Expedition, F-150, F-250 Through F-550, Grand Marquis, Navigator, Ranger, Town Car and Windstar – Seat Belt Buckle Retention

Q & A (updated July 25th)

Q.21 **Is 'Special Handling' approved for Lincoln vehicles affected by 01S21?**
A.21 Yes, Dealers will be reimbursed the cost of collecting, washing, filling with fuel, etc. in line with established guidelines. This applies to Lincoln vehicles, affected by this recall, that have been delivered to customers. The published bulletin will be updated to reflect this change.

Q.22 **Why are some parts on restriction?**
A.22 Inventory has been restricted on the low vehicle volume seat belt buckles to ensure continued parts availability. The restricted parts are being monitored daily and will be removed from the restriction at the earliest date possible. Since the program launch, the following five have been removed: 1W7Z-5461202-AAC, 1L7Z-7861203-CAB, 1L7Z-78612B18-AAC, 1L7Z-78612B18-AAA and 1L3Z-1561203-BAC.

Q.23 **Why are there maximum order quantity (MOQ) restrictions?**
A.23 By the week of 7/23 we will have available stock on all 64 seat belt buckles involved in the campaign, inventory levels are limited but adequate to meet projected requirements. To ensure stock remains available, MOQs have been established by vehicle volume. For instance, the highest used seat belt buckles have MOQs of 5 while the restricted ones are 1. All but 24 parts can be ordered via DOES II, and these parts have an MOQ ranging from 2 to 5.

Q.24 **What does SIR mean?**
A.24 SIR stands for Seat Integrated Restraints. This means the seat belt retractors are in the seat versus the non-SIR vehicles, which have the retractors on the B-pillar.

Q.25 **Which seat belt buckle do I use for a F250/550 SD Super Cab with 40/20/40 bench?**
A.25 All SIR equipped F250/550 SD Super Cab use 1C3Z-2861203-AAA on the driver side and 1C3Z-1861202-AAA on the passenger side.

Q.26 What are the seat belt buckle service numbers for F250/550 Super Duty vehicles with blue interiors?
A.26 The F250/550 SD Regular and Crew Cab driver Bucket seat uses the Dark Denim Blue buckle 1C3Z-2561203-CAB. The F250/550 SD Regular and Crew Cab driver hand 40/20/40 Bench use the Dark Denim Blue buckle 1C3Z-2561203-BAB. All use the Dark Denim Blue buckle 1L7Z-7861202-AAF for the passenger side.

Q.27 Is there an easy way to check part status on the seat belt buckles?
A.27 A daily status of all seat belt buckles can be found on the QCDealer.com's main page under What's New. The items picks are "Updated Safety Recall 01S21 Seat Belt Buckle Parts Availability Listing" and "Updated Safety Recall 01S21 Seat Belt Buckle Parts Overall Status Listing."

Ford Motor Company

A.R. O'Neill
Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
www.ownerconnection.com

July 2001

01S21

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect, which relates to motor vehicle safety, exists in some of the affected seat belt buckles in certain vehicles.

Ford Motor Company apologizes for this situation and wants to assure you that, with your assistance, we will correct this condition.

What the issue is …

In some of the included vehicles, it may be possible that either or both of the front, outboard seat belt buckles may not fully latch if the restraint is fastened slowly or using very low force. In the event of an accident, the restraint system may not provide the designed level of occupant protection, increasing the risk of personal injury.

What can I do now?

Always push the seat belt tongue into the buckle "quickly" and "firmly". **After the buckle is latched, inspect the red release button to be sure it has returned to the top of its travel (See the included illustrations). If the red release button has not returned to the top of its travel, depress the red release button and again, quickly and firmly, insert the tongue into the buckle. If the release button does not return to its full up position, the buckle may not be fully latched. As soon as possible, please go to your dealership so they can inspect your vehicle.**

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

Ford Motor Company and its dealer network will inspect and, if necessary, repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). If you do not already have a servicing dealer, please access www.dealerconnection.com for addresses, maps, and driving instructions to the nearest dealers.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this inspection or repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling requirements, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Recall 01S21. Your vehicle's front, outboard seat belt buckles will be inspected utilizing a special tool. If the buckle passes the inspection, replacement of the buckle is not necessary. If any seat belt buckle fails the inspection process, it will be replaced free of charge. When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. However, if you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Need a rental?…

Your dealer is authorized to provide a rental vehicle at no charge (except for fuel and insurance) if your vehicle is at the dealership waiting for replacement parts.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us so we can update our records. If you have sold the vehicle, the information you provide on the postcard will be used to notify the new owner about this Safety Campaign.

If you still have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager for assistance. If you still have concerns, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

Call (866) 436-7332

Office Hours (Eastern Time Zone)
Monday – Friday: 8AM – 11PM
Saturday: 9AM – 6PM

Hearing impaired call (800) 232-2952
TDD for the hearing impaired.

Or you may contact us through the Internet …

www.ownerconnection.com

If you are still having trouble getting your vehicle repaired and without charge, you may write to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline at 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393.

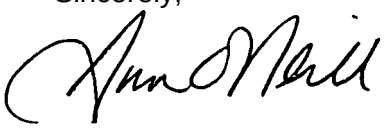
QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care service is there for you all year long.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret any inconvenience caused by this notification, we stand committed with our Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. Your dealer is committed to your satisfaction and many are open with extended hours and on Saturdays.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company, providing automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



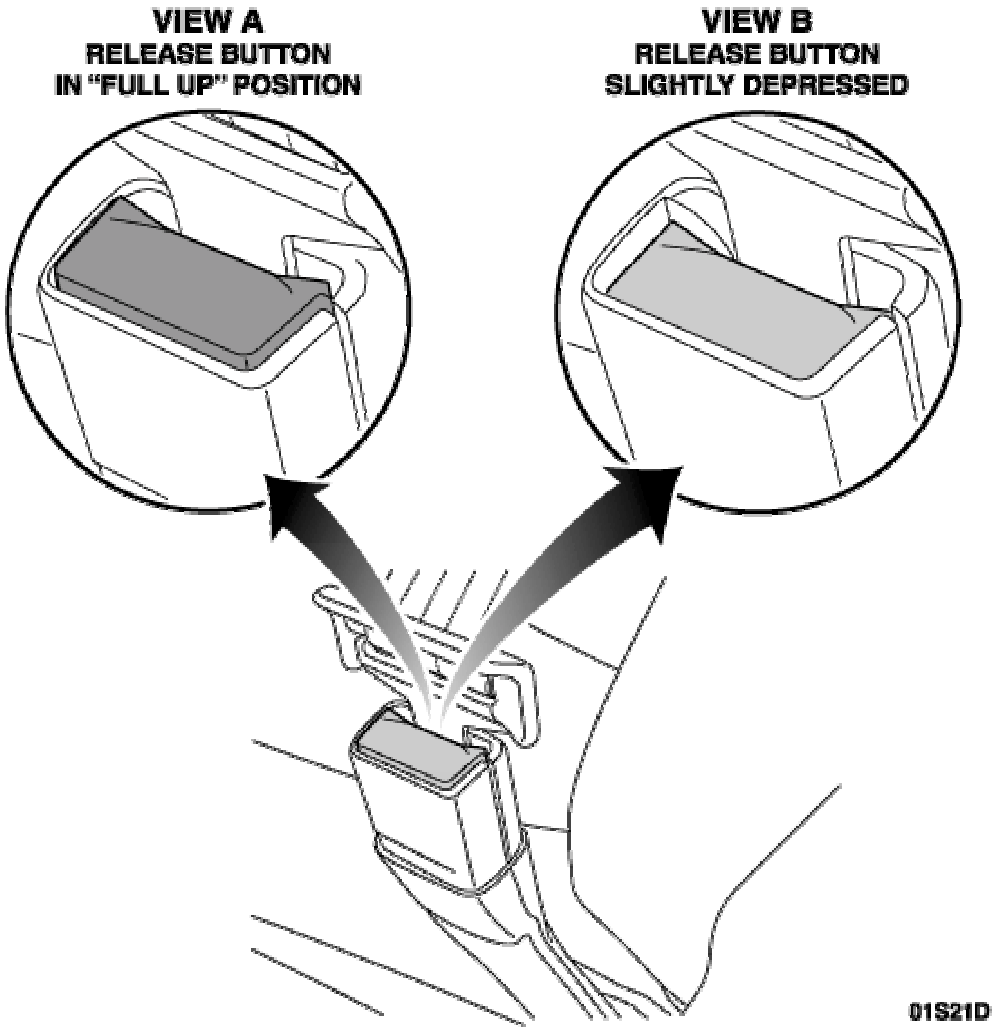
Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

What does a properly latched seat belt buckle look like?

The illustration below shows the red seat belt buckle release button in both the **"full up",** or properly latched position (View A) and in a "**slightly depressed**" position (View B). Notice: When properly latched, the red release button will return to the position it was in before the tongue was inserted into the seat belt buckle.

If your buckle release button looks like that shown in View B, the buckle is only partially latched. Remove the tongue from the buckle by pressing the red release button. After removal, reinsert the tongue quickly and firmly into the buckle. Be sure that the red release button is in the position shown in View A ("full up" position) after insertion.



© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company